A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE
MBBS, PhD, FRACP
Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist
PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

22 April 2026

Dr Maurice Kohn
West Med Medical Centre

Dear Dr Kohn,

Re: Mrs Anna Cassar
DOB: 1955-02-24
Address: 26 Arbour Boulevard, BURNSIDE HEIGHTS, VIC, 3023

Summary

- **Management of Crohn's disease symptoms including diarrhoea and abdominal pain.**
- **Cessation of amitriptyline due to severe constipation.**
- **Commencement of a nine-week budesonide taper for symptom control.**
- **Surveillance gastroscopy, colonoscopy, and MRI scheduled for September 2024.**
- **No action required by you.**

I had the pleasure of conducting an in-person review with Anna Cassar. As you are aware, we had previously attempted to up-titrate her amitriptyline to manage her gastrointestinal symptoms; however, she has had to cease this medication. She reached a dose of 50 mg but experienced six weeks of severe constipation without any corresponding improvement in her pain. Since discontinuing the amitriptyline in February, her chronic diarrhoea has returned, and she is unfortunately experiencing nocturnal faecal incontinence.

Anna described two recent episodes of severe abdominal pain in January and March that necessitated calling an ambulance, though she did not attend the emergency department. She noted that the pain radiates to her back and is associated with vomiting, which generally resolves the episode. While she was concerned regarding a pancreatic origin for this pain, I have reassured her that this is unlikely, though we will remain vigilant.

Regarding her current medications, Anna is taking 5 mg of escitalopram for anxiety. She noted that 10 mg left her feeling overly sedated. Her anxiety is currently focused on her upcoming overseas

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travel in June, particularly regarding the logistics of managing her bowel symptoms while in transit.

Impression and Plan

I have initiated a tapering course of budesonide, particularly to provide stability for her upcoming trip to Europe. The regimen will consist of 9 mg daily for three weeks, 6 mg for three weeks, and finally 3 mg for three weeks. I have also provided her with a script for her maintenance azathioprine at 150 mg daily.

We will undertake a stool calprotectin test and bloods to evaluate for active inflammation. I do not believe an urgent colonoscopy is required given her most recent review in November (despite Anna's instance); however, I have scheduled a surveillance gastroscopy and colonoscopy for September. This will coincide with her scheduled pancreatic MRI to allow for a thorough reassessment upon her return to Australia. I will review Anna again following these investigations.

Yours sincerely,

A/Prof Chamara Basnayake
Gastroenterologist

All appointments and enquires
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Endoscopy locations
Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
Hobson Healthcare Sydenham
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
St Vincent's Private Hospital
59 Victoria Pde, Fitzroy, 3065